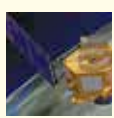


INVENTING THE TELESCOPE

The linear historical account of telescopes obscures a far more interesting, convoluted story. From Newton's reflecting mirrors to the lenses that had been used since Galileo, how many great minds does it take to invent a telescope?
<http://dgit.in/telescope1>

SURVEILLANCE STARTS AT HOME

This story is part of Motherboard vice's new series called 'when spies come home'. It's all about powerful surveillance software and the 'Stalkerware' ordinary people use nowadays to eavesdrop on each other's phones.
<http://dgit.in/stalkerware>

AN ELEGY FOR EARTH OBSERVING-1

Earth Observing-1 wasn't supposed to survive as long as it did. Operating on a shoe-string budget, the spartan satellite outlasted its warranty 15-fold, and changed the way we do space-based imaging of our planet.
<http://dgit.in/EarthEye>

HOW 'AMAZON GO' WORKS

Amazon announced their Amazon Go retail shop in December last year – a retail store where you could simply walk in, grab items and walk out. But how does that work? Are current age computer visions really good enough for it?
<http://dgit.in/GoTheory>

Research says Indians want to upgrade phones in 12 months, but should you?

Counterpoint Research's new survey says Indian consumers want to upgrade their smartphones within 12 months.

– By Prasad Banerjee

A survey conducted amongst over 1500 respondents has led Counterpoint Research to believe that Indian consumers want to switch to a new phone within 12 months. The report says features like 4G VoLTE, better battery and memory are reasons for consumers wanting to switch. "As per the survey, two in three users plan to upgrade to a new mobile phone in the next 12 months. This is a departure from an average of 24-30 months to under 20 months upgrade cycle," says the report.

Further, Counterpoint's report says that one of the factors for users to look for 4G LTE smartphones is Reliance Jio's VoLTE only network. Also, with smartphones becoming a big part of people's lives, better memory, storage and battery have become important requirements.

Should you be upgrading within 12 months?

In a word, the answer is no. Having tested most smartphones today, we can attest to the fact that most users do not need to upgrade within 12 months.

If you have a 3G/2G phone, then an upgrade is warranted. However, if you happen to have bought a phone within the last 12 months, hold on to it. Android phones do slow down over time, but they

really do not get to the point where they become unusable. As a rule of thumb, there's only one real reason to "upgrade" your smartphone, that is if it stops working entirely. Let us explain why.

Let's assume you purchased a Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 a few months ago. Here's what your phone is missing right now:



Sony Xperia XA dual

Android Nougat. It's indeed a big miss, but alternatives aren't much better any way. You have a reasonable camera to work with, 4GB of RAM, 64GB of storage and a balanced Snapdragon 625 SoC. It's more than what most users need right now. Xiaomi announced an Android Nougat beta at launch, so chances are that you'll be getting an update soon enough. If you've purchased a Motorola device, you probably are on the latest software already.

Phone's normally start lagging and become harder to use once you have

about 1GB or less space left on it. Over time, you will block up some of the RAM, which will reduce performance. The more apps you load, the more the processor load. But absolutely none of it will make your phone unusable. The Redmi Note 4 and most of its compatriots run on able and up-to-date hardware.

There's another big reason to not upgrade your smartphone. Almost all numbers today point towards growing demand in the sub-15K range. In this range, there are phones that are good, some that are better and some that are downright bad. However, none of these devices can be considered an "upgrade" to their counterparts. In fact, stagnation in the smartphone market has made the term "upgrade" obsolete. Like we said above, buying a VoLTE enabled phone after a 3G phone is an upgrade, but buying a Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 or any other "budget beast" just offers you incremental updates instead of real upgrades.

The above is true for every best selling phone out there right now. Few smartphones today warrant an upgrade within 12 months, so if you are planning an upgrade, you should make sure your phone is simply refusing to turn on. If not, stick with it, at least for 18 months.
<http://dgit.in/IndianPH>